

BizSkill Revision Guide

TCS IPA Exam 2026 — Business Skills Section

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50 Practice Questions with Answers & Explanations

Set 1	Questions from Mock Assessment (Assessment Screenshots)	20 Qs
Set 2	Additional Practice — Workplace & Communication Etiquette	15 Qs
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✓ **Green highlighted option** = Correct Answer | *Italic text below each question* = Short explanation

SET 1 — Mock Assessment Questions (with Corrected Answers)

These are the 20 questions from your practice assessment screenshots, with the verified correct answers (a few differ from what was originally selected — check the explanation for each).

Q1. Which of the following factors should be considered while wearing ties?

A. Tie should be of the same colour as that of the shirt.

✓ B. The tip of your tie should always touch the beltline.

C. Tie should always be bold and striking in design so as to add charisma.

D. None

Why: The standard etiquette rule is that a tie's tip should just touch the belt line — not too short, not too long.

Q2. Select the effective sentence.

A. The manager's laissez-faire way of thinking has led to an efficient work culture in the team.

✓ B. The manager's laissez-faire attitude has led to an efficient work culture in the team.

C. The manager's attitude of non-interference has led to an efficient work culture in the team.

D. The manager has the practice of letting people act without interference which helped create trust within the team and also created a healthy work environment.

Why: An "effective sentence" is concise and uses the precise term correctly. Option 2 uses "laissez-faire attitude" correctly and concisely — the long paraphrase in option 4 is wordy, not "effective."

Q3. Which statements are true with regard to 'customer' and 'client'?

A. A customer is a person who purchases the goods and services from the business, in exchange for money.

✓ B. All options are correct

C. A person or firm who looks for professional service from the business is known as a client.

D. If a client is satisfied with the services provided by a business, the temporary relationship may turn into a long lasting one.

Why: All three individual statements accurately describe customers and clients, so 'All options are correct' is right.

Q4. How can one develop assertiveness?

A. By showing empathy.

B. By showing sympathy.

C. By ensuring that others agree with your points.

D. By being open to feedback

E. By accepting everyone's views.

F. By respecting everyone's views.

A. A,B,C,F

B. ALL

C. A,C,D,E

✓ D. A,D,F

Why: Assertiveness = empathy + openness to feedback + respecting (not necessarily accepting) others' views. Sympathy, forcing agreement, and blanket acceptance of all views are not assertiveness traits.

Q5. As you are working, you find that certain queries need to be clarified with the client. Upon opening the Instant Messenger, you find the status of the client as 'available'. What would you do?

✓ **A. Check whether the client is free to chat. Post your query if the client is free. Else check for a suitable time.**

B. Assuming that the client knows you, you may post your queries directly.

C. Type "Hi" to the client and then post your queries.

D. You are not supposed to use the chat feature in a situation like this.

Why: Even if status shows 'available,' it's polite to confirm the person is genuinely free before posting queries.

Q6. Cathy sends an invitation to her team members for an unplanned meeting to discuss a new feature to be added in the project. Due to a shortage of time, she sends the invitation without an agenda. Choose the right option.

✓ **A. An agenda needs to be shared along with the meeting invite.**

B. For meetings that happen at short notice an agenda is not necessary.

C. It is alright to send the invitation without a meeting agenda

D. The agenda can be discussed at the start of the meeting. Hence, this is not an issue.

Why: An agenda should always accompany a meeting invite, regardless of how much notice is given, so attendees can prepare.

Q7. You meet your colleague in a shopping mall. Choose the best response.

A. Greet the person and abruptly end the conversation by saying "bye" as you don't have anything to say.

B. Don't pay attention to your colleague as you don't want to talk about work on weekends.

C. Say "Hi" to that person and close the conversation by saying that you are late for the movie.

✓ **D. Say, "Hi. How is your day?" After exchanging pleasantries, you may close the conversation.**

Why: Basic social courtesy means exchanging brief, warm pleasantries before moving on, rather than ignoring or abruptly dismissing a colleague.

Q8. Amy, a client-partner from Germany is having a discussion with the project team in India. Amy finds it uncomfortable when a few of the team members start speaking in their regional language amongst themselves. She feels a bit lost. What can the team do differently?

A. The team need not do anything.

B. Usage of native language in a meeting is a common occurrence.

✓ **C. The team lead should have stressed the usage of a common language, that is English, among team members.**

D. Both 2 and 3

Why: In multicultural/multilingual meetings, sticking to a common language (English) ensures everyone, including external stakeholders, feels included.

Q9. Which statement is more polite and respectful to a native English speaker?

A. My wife and myself attended the wedding.

✓ **B. My wife and I attended the wedding.**

C. Me and my wife attended the wedding

D. Myself and my wife attended the wedding.

Why: "My wife and I" is the grammatically correct and conventionally polite form. "Me and my wife" is grammatically incorrect, and "myself"/"my wife and myself" misuse the reflexive pronoun.

Q10. The elevators are always crowded at ABC facility. What rules of elevator etiquette should be followed?

✓ A. Only 1 and 2

- B. Always allow the people inside the elevator to disembark before entering the elevator.
- C. Those standing next to the elevator door should step out to enable others to disembark.
- D. Employees must keep pressing the elevator button so as to ensure speedy functioning of the elevator.

Why: Letting people exit first (option 2) and stepping aside to let others out (option 3) are correct etiquette rules — combined as 'Only 1 and 2.' Repeatedly pressing the button does not speed up an elevator.

Q11. Case Study: Chris Hurn stayed at the Ritz Carlton Hotel in Amelia Island on a vacation with his family, where his son accidentally left behind his dearest stuffed animal, Joshie. Chris told his son that Joshie decided to stay a little longer there. He called the hotel to enquire whether they have Joshie... Luckily, they found it and told Chris that they will send Joshie over. To support Chris's story, the hotel staff took a few pictures of Joshie having a massage, by the poolside, and taking a drive along the beach. Please choose the correct options which were followed by the hotel staff.

- A. The staff was innovative.
- B. The staff identified the problem as an opportunity.
- C. The staff collaborated with the customer.
- D. The staff believes in business value of fair-mindedness.
- E. The staff was willing to experiment.

A. A,C,E

B. A,C,D,E

✓ C. ALL

D. A,B,C,E

Why: This is a classic customer-service case study (real Ritz-Carlton story) — the staff demonstrated innovation, opportunity recognition, collaboration, fair-mindedness, AND experimentation. All five qualities (A–E) are typically credited in this example.

Q12. Jalaja wore a saree to work. Since she was sporting an ethnic look, she also wore big and bold accessories with flowers in her hair. Make-up however was minimal. Which of the following statements are correct.

- A. Flowers in the hair and big accessories are inappropriate when make up is minimal. Make up should have been a bit bold so as to suit her bold attire.
- B. She should not have worn saree as it is not a formal wear. Flowers in the hair and bold accessories are also not acceptable. Minimum make-up is appropriate.
- C. She should not have worn flowers as it could cause allergic reaction for others. Bold accessories can be quite distracting and is best avoided.

✓ D. None of the above

Why: A saree is acceptable ethnic/formal workwear, and none of the critical statements about her styling hold up as valid workplace grooming rules — so 'None of the above' is correct.

Q13. Scenario: Hugh, Tom & Thanos are in a meeting.

Hugh: I believe we should update the UI. What do you suggest Tom?

Tom: I am not sure... What is Thanos' idea?

Thanos: I think we can add a few new features to the website. I am sure you will agree.

Tom: Yeah... But... I think...

Hugh: Even I think its a great idea. The client will be impressed with the new features. Wouldn't he?

Tom could you do us a favor and add the features that we discussed yesterday?

Tom: Umm... Yeah...

How differently could Tom have responded?

A. I feel adding new features will affect our deadline but I do understand it is important for you. However, my plate is full at the moment. I am worried that it would affect my current work which I have to deliver by tomorrow. Why don't you ask Stuart for help? I am sure he will be able to do it.

B. I am very sorry Hugh. If I do your work then I won't be able to do my work.

C. Thanos, please ask Stuart to do it. I am very busy at the moment.

✓ **A. Only A**

B. Only C

C. Only B

D. All

Why: Option A is the assertive response — it acknowledges the request, explains the real constraint, and offers a constructive alternative, rather than bluntly refusing (B) or redirecting rudely (C).

Q14. What is true about being Agile?

A. Agile teams can never fail.

B. Agile is driven by action.

C. Agile teams do not experiment.

D. Agile teams do not believe in rationalism.

A. B,D

✓ **B. ONLY B**

C. A,B

D. C,D

Why: Agile methodology emphasizes action and iteration. Agile teams CAN fail (and learn from it), DO experiment, and DO use rational/data-driven decisions — so only B is true.

Q15. Replace the underlined phrase to make the sentence simple. The memo is not effective by virtue of the fact that it is lengthy.

A. the reason because

✓ **B. because**

C. as the reason is

D. on the account of the fact that

Why: "Because" is the simplest, most direct replacement for the wordy phrase "by virtue of the fact that."

Q16. Scenario: Amitabh, Jaya and Aishwarya are in a meeting.

Amitabh: Jaya I believe you have an idea that you want to discuss.

Jaya: I do indeed. Why don't we come up with interactive activities with the audience to boost our sales rather than giving discounts?

Amitabh: I would be convinced if you could share some facts Jaya.

Jaya: I know this idea will work. It is an effective measure to increase our profits.

Aishwarya: I am not sure...

Jaya: Oh you are never sure Aishwarya.

Amitabh: Go ahead Aishwarya I would like to hear your ideas.

Aishwarya: Never mind we will go with Jaya's ideas. But don't blame me if it doesn't work out (rolling her eyes).

Please choose the correct options.

A. Aishwarya: Aggressive / Jaya: Passive-aggressive / Amitabh: Passive

✓ B. Aishwarya: Passive-aggressive / Jaya: Aggressive / Amitabh: Assertive

C. Aishwarya: Aggressive / Jaya: Aggressive / Amitabh: Passive aggressive

D. Aishwarya: Aggressive / Jaya: Aggressive / Amitabh: Assertive

Why: Aishwarya's sarcastic remark and eye-roll while outwardly agreeing = passive-aggressive. Jaya dismisses Aishwarya's hesitation bluntly = aggressive. Amitabh invites input calmly and stays neutral = assertive.

Q17. Which is not a part of pre-writing process?

✓ A. Proof reading

B. Outlining

C. Thinking

D. Free writing

Why: Proofreading happens AFTER writing is complete, not before. Thinking, outlining, and free writing are all part of the pre-writing stage.

Q18. We can share funny videos with:

A. Everyone. All of us need a good laugh every once in a while.

B. Clients. Keeping a client happy is great for business.

✓ C. It is best to refrain from sending videos unrelated to work.

D. Managers. This will help us to build a good relationship with them.

Why: Non-work-related content, even harmless humor, is best avoided in professional/official communication channels.

Q19. What are the main features offered in the mail application apart from e-mail?

a) Schedule meetings and appointments.

b) Invite stakeholders for a meeting.

c) Accept/decline invitation.

d) Set reminders to attend meetings.

A. a,b & c

B. None

C. b, c & d

✓ D. a, b, c & d

Why: Modern mail/calendar applications (like Outlook) support all four features: scheduling, invitations, accept/decline, and reminders.

Q20. Vivian had around 5 minutes before an important meeting. He found a client mail in his inbox that asked for an additional requirement. He is of the belief that emails need to be responded to promptly. Vivian wanted to be on time for the meeting and also wanted to reply to the client. What should he do?

A. Send across a one liner "The requirement would be incorporated".

✓ B. Take time after the meeting and reply to the client, after analysis the requirement in detail.

C. Forward it to a team member asking to respond on his behalf.

D. Reply to the mail immediately as the client's needs should be prioritized.

Why: A rushed, un-analyzed reply risks miscommunication. It's better to attend the meeting on time and send a thoughtful, accurate response afterward.

SET 2 — Workplace & Communication Etiquette (Practice)

Q1. During a video call with a client, your internet connection starts lagging and your video freezes. What should you do?

A. Continue the call assuming the client hasn't noticed.

✓ **B. Inform the client politely that you're facing connectivity issues and either switch to audio-only or ask to reconnect.**

C. End the call without explanation and message them later.

D. Ask a colleague to continue the call on your behalf without informing the client.

Why: Transparency and proactive communication maintain professionalism and trust, even when technical issues are outside your control.

Q2. Which of the following is the most professional way to end a work email?

A. Thanks!!!

✓ **B. Best regards,**

C. TTYL

D. Cheers mate

Why: "Best regards" is a neutral, universally professional sign-off appropriate for formal and semi-formal business communication.

Q3. Priya is in an open-plan office and needs to take a personal call. What is the most appropriate action?

A. Take the call loudly at her desk since everyone does it.

✓ **B. Step outside or move to a private area to take the call.**

C. Ignore the call and deal with it after work hours only.

D. Ask her teammates to lower their voices while she takes the call at her desk.

Why: Moving to a private space respects both her own privacy and her colleagues' ability to focus — a core element of workplace etiquette.

Q4. How should one handle disagreement with a manager's decision during a team meeting?

A. Stay silent and comply immediately.

B. Raise the concern respectfully during the meeting with supporting reasons.

C. Argue loudly to prove your point.

D. Discuss it privately with teammates after the meeting to build opposition.

✓ **A. Only B**

B. A, D

C. B, C

D. A, B, C, D

Why: Assertive communication means voicing disagreement respectfully and constructively in the right setting — not staying silent (passive), arguing (aggressive), or building opposition behind the scenes (passive-aggressive).

Q5. Which sentence is grammatically correct and appropriate for a formal email?

A. Please revert back to me at the earliest.

✓ **B. Please respond at your earliest convenience.**

C. Kindly do the needful ASAP.

D. Please to reply me soon.

Why: "Revert back" is redundant (revert already means "go back"). "Do the needful" and similar phrasing is considered outdated/informal in modern professional English.

Q6. A team member consistently interrupts others during meetings. What is the most professional way for the team lead to address this?

A. Publicly call them out mid-meeting to embarrass them into stopping.

✓ B. Speak to them privately after the meeting and provide constructive feedback.

C. Ignore it since it isn't a big deal.

D. Complain to HR immediately without speaking to the individual first.

Why: Constructive feedback is most effective when delivered privately and respectfully, preserving the person's dignity while addressing the behavior.

Q7. You receive a work email at 11 PM from your manager with no urgency indicated. What should you do?

A. Reply immediately to show dedication.

✓ B. Reply during your normal working hours the next day, unless it's marked urgent.

C. Ignore it completely, even the next day.

D. Call your manager right away to ask if it's urgent.

Why: Respecting work-life boundaries is a two-way responsibility; responding within normal hours (unless explicitly urgent) is professional and sustainable.

Q8. Case Study: Raj, a manager, notices that a new team member, Meera, has made a mistake in a client report. The report has already been sent. What should Raj do first?

A. Publicly reprimand Meera in the next team meeting.

✓ B. Contact the client immediately to correct the error, then address the mistake privately with Meera.

C. Ignore the mistake since the report is already sent.

D. Ask another team member to inform the client instead of doing it himself.

Why: Prioritizing the client relationship (damage control) comes first, followed by private, constructive coaching — not public blame.

Q9. Which of the following best reflects 'active listening' in a workplace conversation?

A. Nodding while thinking about your response.

B. Paraphrasing what the speaker said to confirm understanding.

C. Interrupting to share a similar experience.

D. Maintaining eye contact and asking clarifying questions.

✓ A. B, D

B. A, C

C. Only A

D. All

Why: Active listening involves genuinely absorbing and confirming understanding (paraphrasing, clarifying questions) — not just appearing attentive or redirecting the conversation to yourself.

Q10. What is the appropriate business attire interpretation for 'smart casual'?

A. Gym wear with sneakers.

✓ B. Collared shirt or blouse with tailored trousers/skirt, and closed-toe shoes.

C. Formal three-piece suit.

D. Any casual T-shirt and jeans combination.

Why: Smart casual bridges formal and casual — neat, put-together clothing without being as rigid as full formal wear.

Q11. Case Study: During a client call, the client mispronounces your colleague's name repeatedly. Your colleague seems uncomfortable but says nothing. What is the best action for you to take?

A. Ignore it since it's not your name being mispronounced.

✓ **B. Politely and naturally correct the pronunciation in the conversation (e.g., "Yes, as [correct pronunciation] mentioned...").**

C. Interrupt the client abruptly to correct them.

D. Message your colleague privately during the call to ask if they mind.

Why: A natural, non-confrontational correction respects both the colleague and the client relationship, and models good allyship.

Q12. Which of the following is the best way to decline a meeting invite you cannot attend?

A. Simply don't respond to the invite.

✓ **B. Decline with a brief explanation and suggest an alternative time or delegate if appropriate.**

C. Accept the invite and just not show up.

D. Reply only with "Can't make it."

Why: Clear, proactive communication with an alternative shows respect for the organizer's time and keeps the meeting on track.

Q13. What is true about giving constructive feedback?

A. Feedback should focus on the person's character.

B. Feedback should be specific and behavior-focused.

C. Feedback should be given in public to set an example.

D. Feedback should include a suggestion for improvement.

✓ **A. B, D**

B. A, C

C. Only C

D. All

Why: Effective feedback targets specific, observable behavior (not personal character) and offers a path forward — and is best delivered privately.

Q14. Case Study: Ankit is asked to present a project update but realizes midway through his slides that he has outdated data. What should he do?

A. Continue presenting the outdated data without mentioning it.

✓ **B. Acknowledge the discrepancy transparently and offer to follow up with corrected data after the meeting.**

C. Stop the presentation entirely and reschedule it.

D. Blame the person who prepared the slides in front of the group.

Why: Transparency and ownership, paired with a clear follow-up plan, maintain credibility better than hiding the error or deflecting blame.

Q15. Which greeting is most appropriate when meeting a senior client for the first time in a formal business setting?

A. "Hey, what's up?"

✓ **B. "Good morning/afternoon, it's a pleasure to meet you."**

C. "Yo, nice to finally meet ya."

D. Just a nod, no verbal greeting.

Why: A warm but formal verbal greeting is the standard for first professional introductions, especially with senior stakeholders.

SET 3 — Feedback, Case Studies & Grammar (Practice)

Q1. You're in a meeting and don't understand a technical term your manager used. What should you do?

A. Nod along and pretend to understand.

✓ B. Politely ask for clarification at an appropriate pause in the conversation.

C. Wait until after the meeting and ask a colleague instead of admitting you didn't understand.

D. Google it silently on your phone during the meeting.

Why: Asking clarifying questions openly is a sign of engagement and professionalism, not weakness — it also prevents miscommunication later.

Q2. Which of the following is the most appropriate subject line for a work email requesting urgent approval?

A. "Hi"

✓ B. "Urgent: Approval Needed for [Project Name] by [Date]"

C. "URGENT!!!!!! PLEASE READ NOW"

D. (Leaving the subject line blank)

Why: A clear, specific subject line with context and a deadline helps the recipient prioritize without resorting to excessive punctuation or vagueness.

Q3. Case Study: During a brainstorming session, Neha shares an idea that gets dismissed quickly by a senior colleague. Later, the same idea is proposed by someone else and is well-received. What is the most appropriate action for the team lead to take?

A. Say nothing since the idea is now being implemented anyway.

✓ B. Acknowledge that Neha originally suggested the idea and credit her contribution.

C. Assume Neha won't mind since the outcome is positive.

D. Privately tell Neha to be more assertive next time, without addressing the situation publicly.

Why: Giving proper credit reinforces psychological safety and encourages continued participation from all team members.

Q4. What is the best approach when you need to give feedback to a peer (not your subordinate)?

A. Avoid giving feedback since they are not your subordinate.

B. Frame feedback using 'I' statements and specific examples.

C. Give feedback only if asked directly.

D. Focus on how their behavior impacts shared outcomes/team goals.

✓ A. B, D

B. A, C

C. Only C

D. All

Why: Peer feedback is valuable and should still be specific, framed constructively, and tied to shared goals — waiting to be asked isn't necessary if the intent is collaborative improvement.

Q5. Which of these is an example of a passive-aggressive response in the workplace?

A. "I disagree with this approach, and here's why..."

✓ B. "Sure, whatever you think is best" (said sarcastically while visibly annoyed).

C. "I need more time to review this before agreeing."

D. "Can we discuss this further before finalizing?"

Why: Passive-aggressive communication involves indirect resistance or sarcasm instead of direct, honest expression of disagreement.

Q6. You're asked to work on a task outside your usual role during a busy week. How should you respond?

A. Refuse outright since it's not your job.

✓ **B. Assess your current workload honestly and communicate your capacity, offering alternatives if needed.**

C. Agree immediately without considering your existing deadlines.

D. Complain to colleagues instead of addressing it with your manager.

Why: Assertive communication means being honest about capacity while remaining solution-oriented, rather than simply saying yes or no reflexively.

Q7. Case Study: A client sends an email late on Friday evening demanding a response by Monday morning on a complex issue. What is the most professional response?

A. Ignore the email until Monday morning.

✓ **B. Acknowledge receipt promptly, and confirm a realistic timeline for a detailed response.**

C. Send a rushed, incomplete response just to meet the deadline.

D. Forward the email to a colleague without informing the client.

Why: A quick acknowledgment manages expectations and shows responsiveness, even if the full resolution needs more time.

Q8. Which of the following best demonstrates cultural sensitivity in a global team meeting?

A. Assuming all participants are comfortable with informal humor.

✓ **B. Being mindful of time zones, avoiding idioms/slang, and checking in on understanding.**

C. Speaking quickly to save time since the meeting is already scheduled.

D. Using region-specific references without explanation.

Why: Cultural sensitivity means adapting communication style so all participants — regardless of background — can fully engage and understand.

Q9. What is true about handling confidential information shared during a meeting?

A. It's fine to discuss it casually with close colleagues.

B. It should only be shared on a need-to-know basis.

C. It can be shared externally if it helps close a sale.

D. It should be handled according to company policy on confidentiality.

✓ **A. B, D**

B. A, C

C. Only D

D. All

Why: Confidentiality should always follow official policy and be restricted to those who genuinely need the information — not shared casually or for convenience.

Q10. Case Study: Arjun notices that a colleague has been taking credit for his work in front of senior management. What is the best first step?

A. Publicly confront the colleague in the next big meeting.

✓ **B. Have a private, direct conversation with the colleague to address the issue.**

C. Complain to other teammates without addressing the colleague directly.

D. Say nothing and let it continue to avoid conflict.

Why: Addressing the issue directly and privately first is the most professional and assertive approach before escalating further if needed.

Q11. Which of the following is the most appropriate way to ask for a deadline extension?

A. "I probably won't finish on time, just so you know."

✓ B. "I'd like to request an extension until [date] due to [specific reason]. Here's my updated plan to ensure quality."

C. Stay silent and miss the deadline without communicating.

D. "Can I get more time? Not sure why but I need it."

Why: A clear, specific, and proactive request with reasoning and a plan reflects accountability and professionalism.

Q12. What is the most appropriate way to handle a scheduling conflict between two important meetings?

A. Skip both meetings.

✓ B. Inform both organizers in advance, prioritize based on importance/urgency, and delegate or request a summary for the one you miss.

C. Attend both simultaneously without informing either organizer.

D. Choose randomly without informing anyone.

Why: Transparent communication and prioritization ensure both meetings are handled respectfully, minimizing disruption.

Q13. Which sentence uses correct professional grammar?

A. "Me and him will handle the client call."

✓ B. "He and I will handle the client call."

C. "Him and me will handle the client call."

D. "Us will handle the client call."

Why: When using compound subjects, the subjective pronoun "I" (not "me") is grammatically correct, and it's polite convention to place it after the other person's name.

Q14. Case Study: During a presentation, a senior stakeholder asks a question you don't know the answer to. What should you do?

A. Make up an answer to appear knowledgeable.

✓ B. Acknowledge you don't have the answer immediately and commit to following up with accurate information.

C. Deflect the question and move to the next slide without addressing it.

D. Ask someone else in the room to answer on your behalf without acknowledging the gap.

Why: Honesty paired with a clear follow-up commitment builds more credibility than guessing or evading the question.

Q15. What is the best approach when receiving negative feedback from a manager?

A. Immediately defend yourself and explain why the feedback is wrong.

✓ B. Listen actively, ask clarifying questions if needed, and reflect before responding.

C. Agree with everything immediately, even if you don't understand it.

D. Ignore the feedback since it wasn't delivered "nicely."

Why: Receiving feedback well means staying open, seeking clarity, and taking time to process rather than reacting defensively.